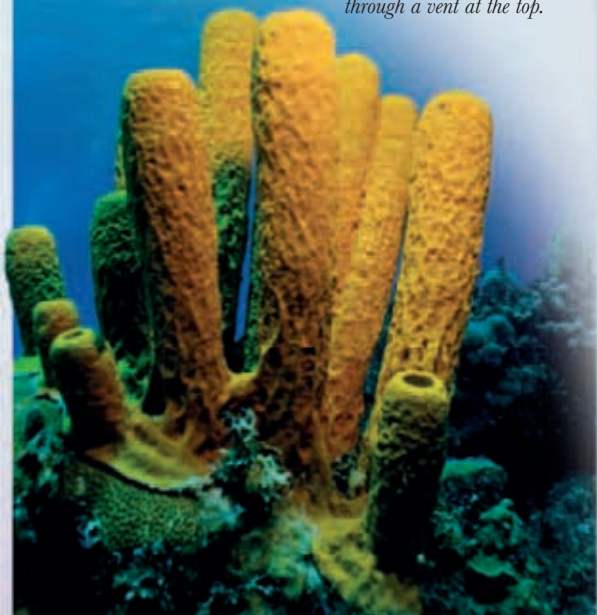


Sponges

Living mainly in the sea, sponges are simple animals with skeletons made of mineral crystals and protein fibers. They live by pumping water through a system of holes, or pores, and filtering out particles of food. The largest kinds are more than 6½ ft (2 m) tall and can be more than 100 years old.

In tubular sponges, water flows in through pores in the sides and out through a vent at the top.



Invertebrates

Invertebrates make up the vast majority of animals. They have an extraordinary variety of shapes, although none has a backbone or any kind of bony skeleton. The total number of species is unknown, but may be more than 10 million.

Flatworms

Flatworms have thin, flat bodies without blood or a heart. Most live in water or in damp habitats on land, but some kinds are parasites living inside other animals.



Turbellarians are free-living predators or scavengers up to 2 ft (60 cm) long. On land, they move by creeping.



A parasitic tapeworm attaches its ribbonlike body to the intestines of vertebrates with suckers and hooks on its head.

Jellyfish, sea anemones, and corals

These invertebrates all have simple bodies with a ring of stinging tentacles around a central mouth. Jellyfish and sea anemones are usually predatory. Reef-building corals often contain microscopic algae, which provide them with some of their food.



Jellyfish have a bell-shaped body trailing stinging tentacles. Some species contain algae and often rest upside down.



Sea anemones live on the seabed. They are often brightly colored with long, stinging tentacles and a suckerlike base.



Soft corals have fleshy or leathery bodies forming colonies with spreading, plantlike shapes.



Reef-building corals live in colonies that build hard, chalky skeletons. The tiny animals occupy cups within the skeleton.

Roundworms

Compared to other worms, roundworms all look similar. They are round in cross-section and do not have segments. They have a tough outer skin, or cuticle, and a tapering head and tail. Roundworms are extremely common in wet and damp habitats and as parasites of animals and plants.

A parasitic roundworm's body moves by curling and uncurling.

